

German BookTok Bestseller Trends

Which characteristics are associated with stronger BookTok chart performance in Germany and what can publishers actually learn from that ?

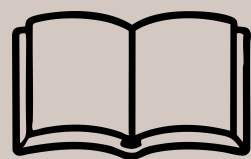


April 2023 – July 2026 · A Data Analysis Report

Jade Smukat

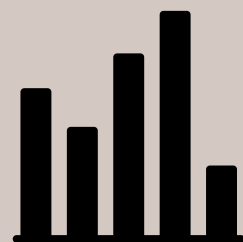
Research Question & Data

Official German BookTok Top 20 | Apr 2023 – Jul 2026



292

Unique Titles



780

Monthly chart
observations



40

months

#Booktok is a community on TikTok for discovering, recommending, and discussing books.



Genre Insights:

Dominance vs. Persistence

127 titles

New Adult / Contemporary
Romance leads by volume

5.8 months

Self-Help / Non-Fiction shows
the highest average chart
persistence

→ High volume does not necessarily
mean long-term chart presence.

BookTok Volume

Number of unique titles

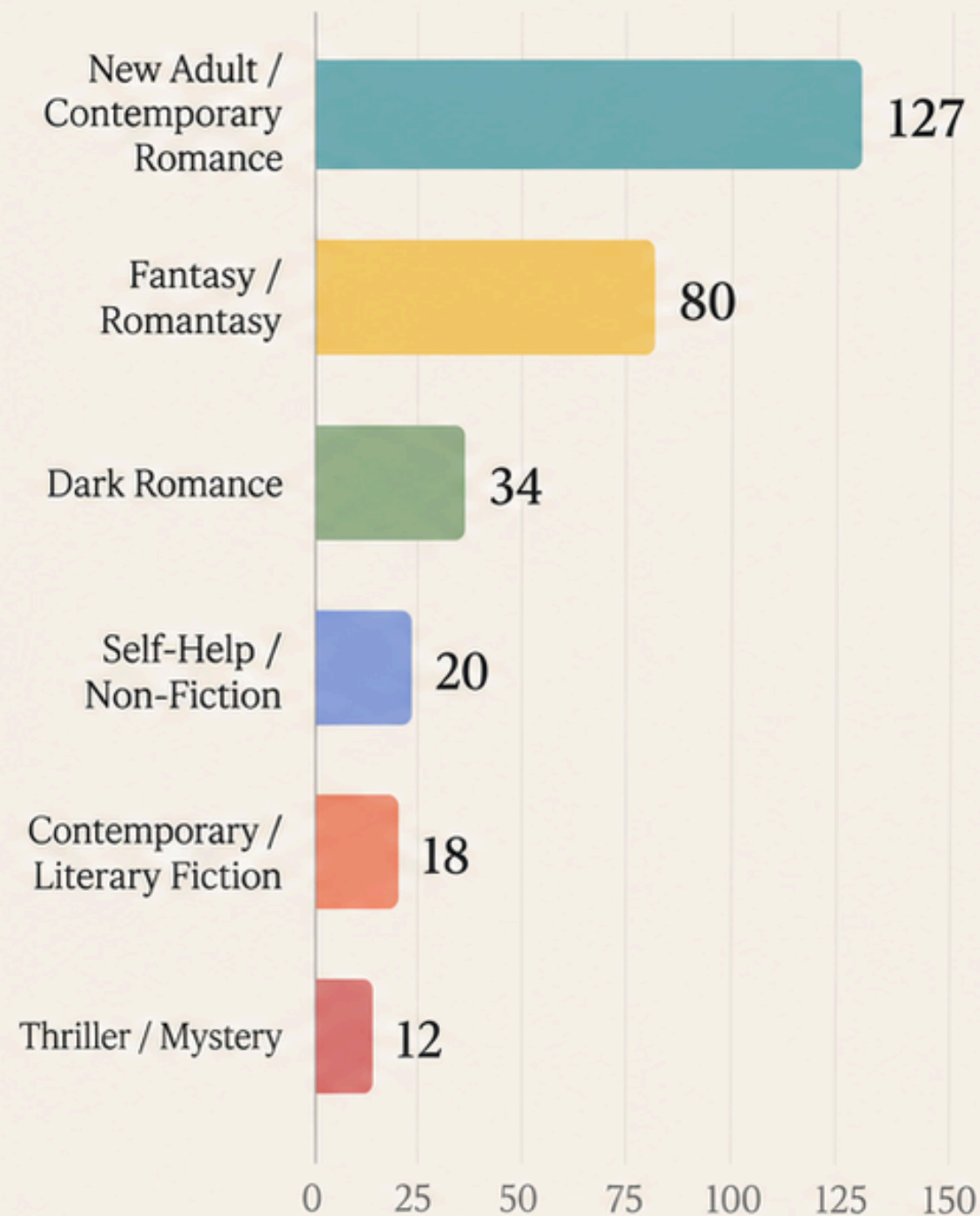
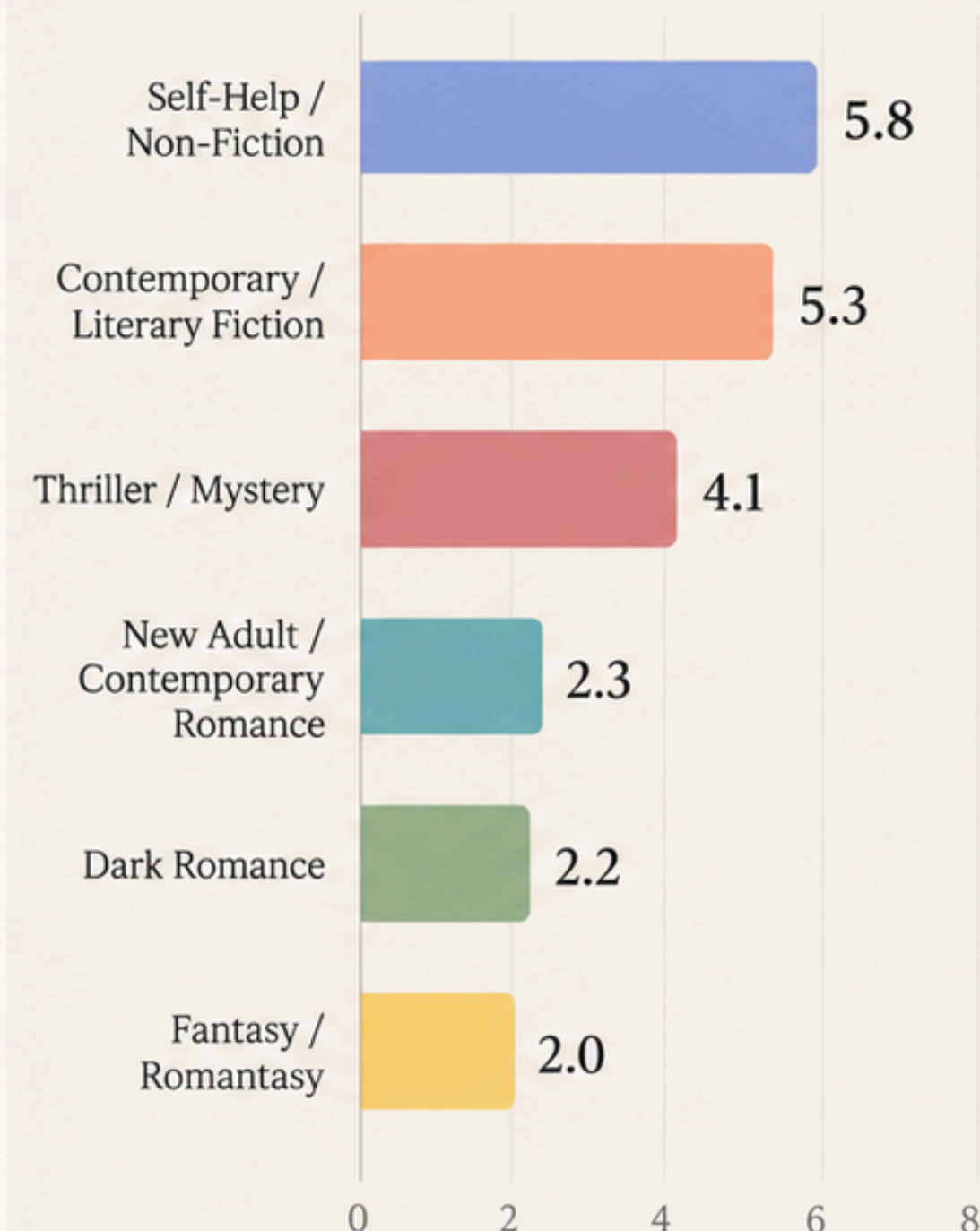


Chart Persistence

Average months in chart



Backlist & Publisher Findings

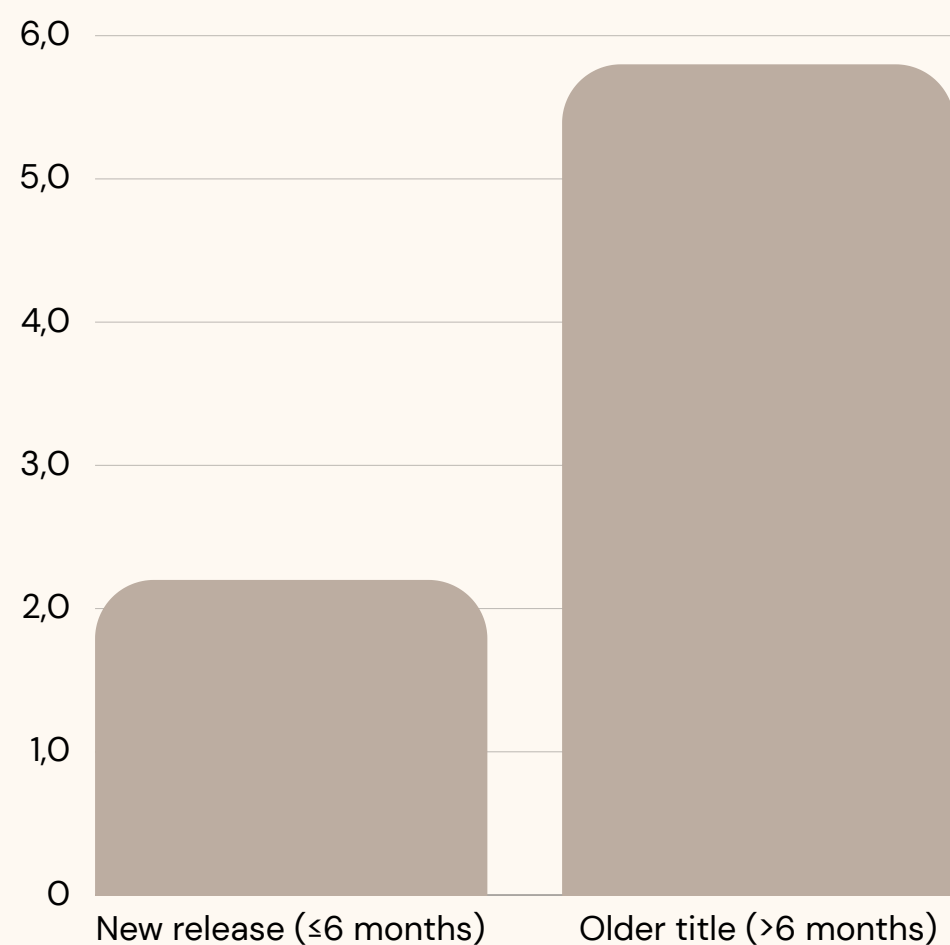
Lifecycle & Publishing Model

2.2 months

New releases (≤ 6 months)

5.8 months

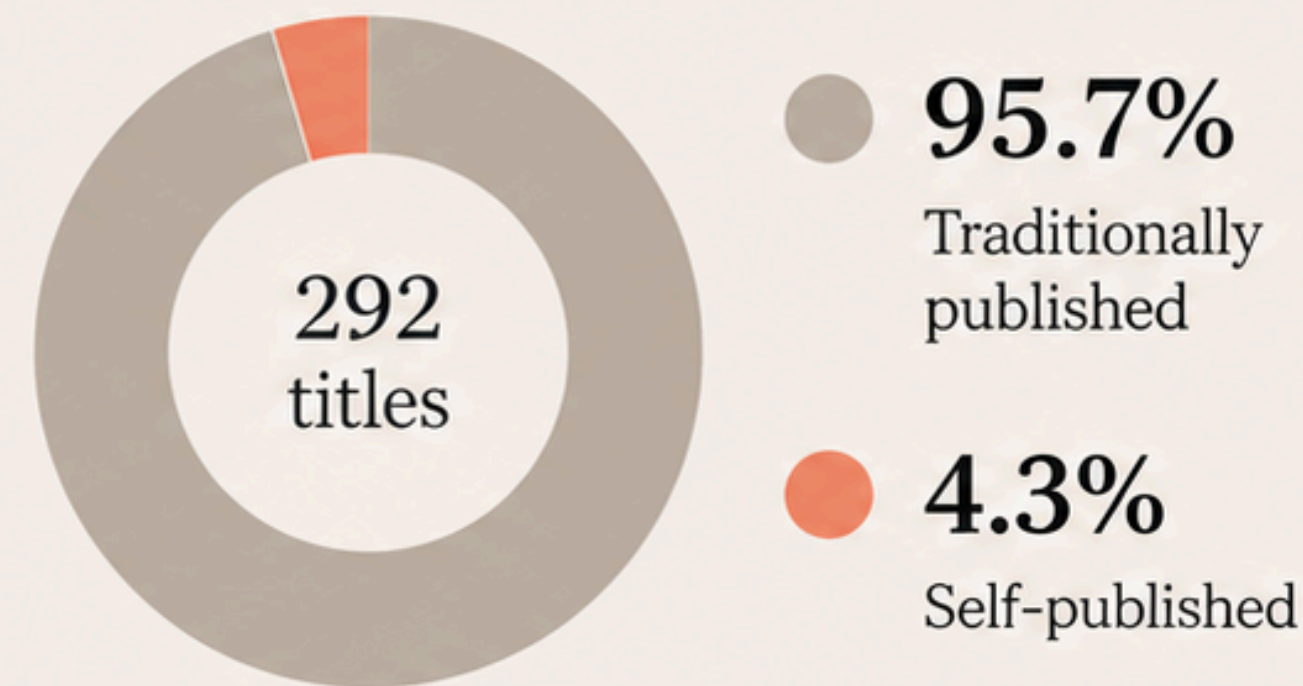
Older titles (> 6 months)



→ BookTok is not only a launch channel — older titles can achieve stronger, longer-term visibility.

Publishing Model

Share of titles in the German BookTok Top 20



Publisher-backed titles still overwhelmingly dominate the official German BookTok chart.

Social media may democratize discovery, but publisher support remains highly relevant.

What Publishers Can Learn from BookTok

Three key insights from the German BookTok Top 20

01

Genre ≠ longevity

New Adult / Contemporary Romance leads by volume, but smaller categories show stronger persistence on the chart.



02

Backlist has real potential

Older titles (> 6 months) stayed on the chart substantially longer than new releases (5.8 vs. 2.2 months on average).



03

Publisher support still matters

95.7% of titles in the German BookTok Top 20 are traditionally published. Self-published titles make up only 4.3%.



BookTok performance is not one-dimensional:
reach, longevity and publishing structure tell different stories.